Scientists and ecologists have often labeled invasive species — an alien species that rapidly multiplies in and disrupts an ecosystem - as completely harmful and disruptive to the ecosystem they invade. Although some of these species do harm to the environments they move to, there is a bias in data collection focusing purely on the harmful aspects. Invasive species can provide some benifits to their new ecosystem such as controling the population of a harmful species, or even profit native species as well. Because of this it is not necessary to control native species.

Throughout the course of research on the topic, scientists have focused on only the harmful effects of invasive species. "For decades, invasion biologists have focused their attention on negative impacts and as a result have accumulated a lot of data pointing in that direction (Source 1, lines 54-56) This shows how misleading the information from invasion biologists could be for the general public. Because there is an immense focus on the negative effects of invasive species some species positive effects may be overshadowed by these negative effects. The common view that invasive species are all bad is inherently flawed, and the positive effects should be looked into.

Speaking of positive effects sometimes other species can be used to control harmful invasive species." In Australia, prickly pear cactus... was growing out of control... The government brought in cactus moth caterpillars to eat the cactuses" (Source 2, lines 36-39) This is a succesful example of an invasive species being controled by an "outside" species. These other species can sometimes be benificial to the ecosystem. The benifits they offer, in this case stopping the

cactus from destroying the land where livestock is raised, shouldn't be ignored because it could be one of the answers to the invasive species problem.

Apart from simply mitigating damage caused by other species, invasive species can also provide an added advantage to the ecosystem they arrive in. "When Dov Sax of Brown University conducted a global study of species invasions on oceanic islands, he found that while the number of birds did sometimes go down after invasions, plant biodiversity usually rose." (Source 4, lines 40-42). This shows how invasive species should be viewed as an asset and discussed more in this light to balance out the negative studies that are more common.

Arguably not all non-native species are a positive introduction to an environment. For example Nutria, a rodent native to South America were brought to North America, primarily to be raised for their fur. When this endeavor failed and they were released into the wild, they became a "major pest in the Gulf Coast and Chesapeake Bay regions of the United States." (Source 2, lines 26-29). They destroyed the habitat by consuming wetland grasses needed as food, nesting sites and shelter for other species (Source 2, lines 31-32). Obviously control of the Nutria was needed in this case, but the Nutria became a problem because of human negligence and greed, not because of introducing them to control another species or the environment. Also, the introduction of Nutria is an extreme example of the damage caused by an invasive species. Not all species causes damage to "the area's food web and habitat" (Source 2, line 32) like the Nutria and "the relentless focus on the damage [of invasive species] risks missing equally important data, and could lead to management decisions

that do more harm than good" (Source 1, lines 23-25). Not all species are harmful they can provide direct and indirect benifits to the envirnment. However, data indicating this has been overlooked for decades in favor of negative stories. The bias associated with how scientists evaluate damage is evident and affects getting the full picture of invasive species and the help they can provide to ecosystems.